

Have Mercy On Me, Lord, My God

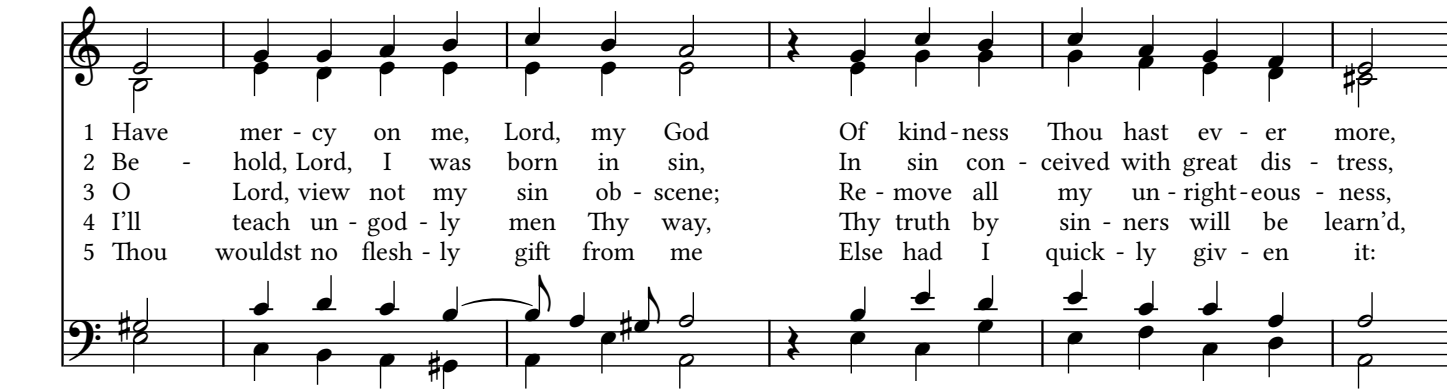
Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott

Cantional (1645), fol. 281

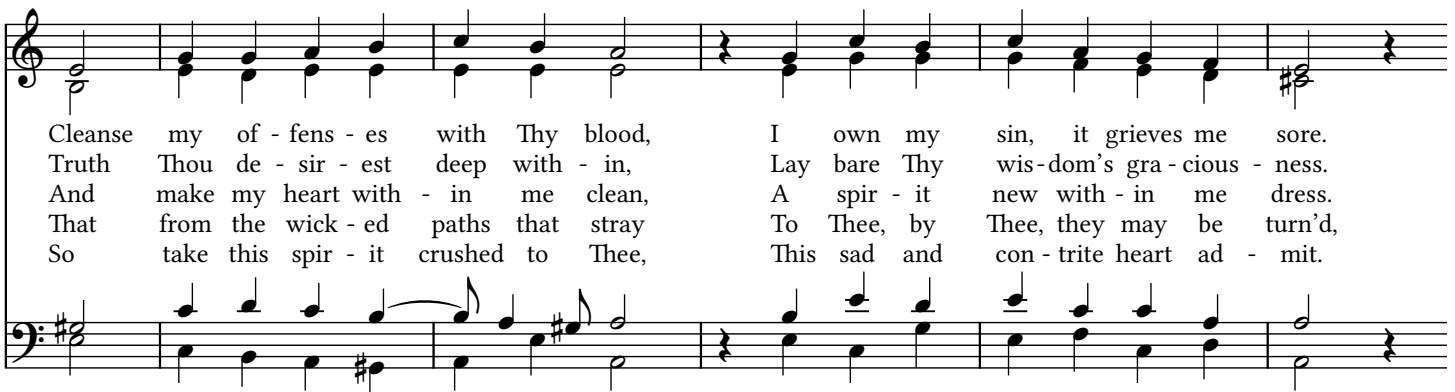
Erhard Hegenwald, tr. Matthew Carver

Johann Hermann Schein (1586–1630)

ed. Jonathan Wessler



1 Have mer - cy on me, Lord, my God Of kind-ness Thou hast ev - er more,
2 Be - hold, Lord, I was born in sin, In sin con - ceived with great dis - tress,
3 O Lord, view not my sin ob - scene; Re - move all my un - right-eous - ness,
4 I'll teach un - god - ly men Thy way, Thy truth by sin - ners will be learn'd,
5 Thou wouldst no flesh - ly gift from me Else had I quick - ly giv - en it:



Cleanse my of - fens - es with Thy blood, I own my sin, it grieves me sore.
Truth Thou de - sir - est deep with - in, Lay bare Thy wis - dom's gra - cious - ness.
And make my heart with - in me clean, A spir - it new with - in me dress.
That from the wick - ed paths that stray To Thee, by Thee, they may be turn'd,
So take this spir - it crushed to Thee, This sad and con - trite heart ad - mit.



I've sinned a - gainst Thy whole com-mand, This truth con - fronts me con - stant - ly;
With hys - sop, Lord, a - sperge my flesh, If washed by Thee, then I am pure,
Oh, from Thy pres-ence cast me not, To take Thy Spir - it do not deign;
Pro - tect me, Sav - ior, God a - lone, From guilt of blood de - liv - er me!
Do not, O God, this gift re - ject, But show Thy kind-ness gra - cious - ly



Be - fore Thee e - vil can - not stand, And Thou art just to pun - ish me.
More white than snow, more glad and fresh, My bones re - joice to find their cure.
Sal - va - tion's joy, O Lord, al - lot, Thy will - ing Spir - it me con - tain.
Thy jus - tice let my tongue make known, Un - lock my lips to wor - ship Thee.
To Zi - on's hill, Thy saints e - lect, Who of - fer right-eous - ness to Thee.